

WEEKLY PROGRESS REPORT

Week 1 - Inception

9th August 2026

Project	Escalent Survey Programming
Title	Agentic AI Platform for Automated Survey Route Discovery, Testing, and Quality Assurance using Large Language Models
Client / Sponsor	Escalent India Pvt. Ltd. · Sameer Saurabh
Period	Week 1 - 3 rd August to 9 th August 2026 · Phase: Inception

Project team

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1. Summary

Week 1 established the project's foundations. The project charter was authored and finalised with the sponsor and faculty mentor; scope was redefined following the opening sponsor discussion; and the architecture, success measures and risk controls are documented. Technical work on Agent 1, the QRE Interpreter, has begun against a publicly available sample QRE

2. Progress this week

Charter and sponsor alignment

- **Created the project charter and finalised it with the sponsor and faculty mentor.** The charter records scope and scope boundaries, the deliverables with dates, the phase plan, success measures, risks and assumptions, data handling and security, and the escalation and change-control route. It is the reference document for all subsequent work.
- Met the sponsor, established the requirement set, shared initial thinking and aligned on expectations and the definition of done.
- Redefined scope following the discussion: the project addresses route discovery, automated testing and quality assurance.
- Escalent supplies the QREs and shares access to the existing survey platform. The Survey Builder agent proposed in the Expression of Interest has been removed; four agents remain and the released capacity has moved to testing and QA.

Current-state understanding and gap analysis

- Mapped the existing workflow end to end specification, programming, QA, amendment, field, tabulation, and confirmed the baseline of roughly 20 QREs per month at 8 to 16 hours of manual testing each.
- Identified the gaps to close: nothing machine-readable sits between the QRE and the programmed survey; coverage is never counted or recorded; and several defect classes cannot be reached by clicking through a survey at all.

QRE analysis

- Analysed a publicly available questionnaire programming specification (NCHS RSS-6, 76 pages, public domain) as a development fixture. Being public domain, it carries no confidentiality constraint.
- Profiled the document - 191 typed question blocks, 188 variables, 21 sections, 122 conditional universes, one bounded loop, one grid - and catalogued the constructs the interpreter must handle. The fixture contains no quotas, terminations or dispositions, which confirms the need for representative Escalent QREs.

Architecture, measurement and platform understanding

- Refined the design of Agent 1
- Fixed ten success metrics, each with its own stated denominator, and documented four project risks with their controls.
- Developed a working understanding of Decipher within the Forsta ecosystem, identified the three artefacts the platform needs from it - survey definition, datamap, and response or test data and defined the integration boundary as a dedicated adapter.

Agent 1 build commenced

- **Drafted the platform-neutral specification schema and began the deterministic extraction path.** Early measurements against the public-domain fixture.

3. Decisions taken

Decision	Rationale and implication
Survey building is out of scope; Decipher is the only platform in scope	Agreed with the sponsor. Removes one agent from the build and concentrates the differentiating value in testing, coverage and audit evidence.
Survey logic is represented as a typed structure rather than free text	The Test Designer must compile it into a condition graph and the QA Adjudicator must assert against it; a text representation would be re-interpreted differently by each consumer.
Confidence is scored per rule from multi-sample agreement, not model self-report	A model reporting high confidence on a rule it read incorrectly is the most dangerous failure mode, because nothing signals it.

Decision	Rationale and implication
Development currently proceeds against a public-domain QRE	Ensures that awaited client inputs delay validation, not development.

4. Risks and controls

Risk	Control in place
Dependency on client inputs (active)	Agents are built against a stub Decipher adapter and a public-domain QRE, so no build activity is blocked; validation is deferred rather than at risk.

5. Awaited inputs

With thanks in advance

- A first set of Escalent QREs, ideally spanning the formats and range of logic complexity the platform will need to handle.
- Decipher test environment access, together with any available API or export documentation.
- **Where convenient, one QRE alongside its programmed Decipher survey.** This is the single most useful input we could receive, as it allows the specification to be checked directly against a built survey.
- Confirmation of the defect classes Escalent considers most important, and if available, examples of defects that have historically reached field.

6. Focus for Week 2 (10 to 16 August)

- **Build Escalent QRE, Survey Platform understanding** to refine the architecture based on the existing parts established by Escalent
- **Freeze the survey specification schema.** Due 16th August, frozen at version 1, alongside the shared-state contract so the team can build in parallel against a stable interface.
- **Stand up the repository, CI and working agreements.** Private repository, access restricted to the team, faculty mentor and any reviewer the sponsor nominates.
- **Continue Agent 1 and begin ground-truth coding.** Extend the interpreter to compound programming instructions, begin the confirmation console, and code ground truth independently of the agent.
- **Run the Decipher spike on receipt of access.** Establish what can be driven programmatically, including response export.